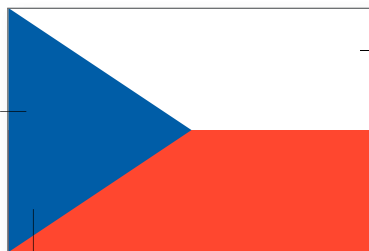


Czech Republic

Ratio: 2:3 **Adopted:** March 30, 1920 **Usage:** National and Civil

The blue triangle was added to distinguish the flag from that of Poland



White and red are the heraldic colors of Bohemia (any similarity to the pan-Slavic colors is coincidental)

Blue represents the state of Moravia

Europe



The **Czech Republic** was part of Austria until 1919, when it merged with Slovakia to form Czechoslovakia. The states separated in 1993.

The first flag of Czechoslovakia was based on the arms, and was white over red. This was identical to the flag of Poland, so a blue triangle was added at the hoist. The flag was banned by the Nazis in 1938 and a horizontal tricolor of white, red, and blue was enforced. The original flag was restored in 1949.

THE NEW CZECH REPUBLIC

When the Czech Republic and Slovakia separated in 1993, the Czechs decided to keep their existing flag, recalling the two principal parts of the country.

The greater coat of arms depicts a quartered shield reflecting the regions of the Czech Republic.

GREATER ARMS OF THE CZECH REPUBLIC

The white lion on a red field is the traditional emblem of Bohemia

The black eagle on a yellow field is taken from the arms of Silesia



The red and white eagle on a blue field is from the arms of Moravia

The Bohemian arms are repeated to fill the shield